

ƒ³⁵, all of which probably go back at least to the 4th century. ƒ³⁵ probably preserves the Original here.

εις αιωνας 2:17 (25.1%)

Here we can rely on the complete collations reflected in *TuT*. There must be well over twenty independent lines of transmission going back to the 5th century, half of which should go back to the 3rd, besides ƒ³⁵. The choice is between singular and plural, one ‘age’ or many. The absence of the article helped to confuse the picture. If the plural is stronger than the singular, then it fits the context better, since Peter is using violent language. I consider that the plural is probably original.

γεννημενα φυσικα 2:12 ⚭ [26%]

Again, besides the overt testimony of ⚭, there must be well over twenty independent lines of transmission going back to the 5th century, half of which should go back to the 3rd, besides ƒ³⁵. The rest of the early uncials (P⁷² omits the participle) attest this order, while around 85% of the MSS attest the verb. The majority variant, by putting the adjective next to the noun, seems to make a more natural construction, but I take it that *φυσικα* is acting like a noun in apposition to *ζωα*, and to help us see this Peter places it after the participle: render, “as unreasoning animals, creatures of instinct made to be caught and destroyed”. I do not doubt that ƒ³⁵ preserves the Original here.

αυξανητε 3:18 [27%]

Imperative or Subjunctive? I take it that Peter is offering a gentler alternative to falling from their steadfastness; render “rather, may you grow in grace...” 5% of the MSS actually move to the Optative; Subjunctive and Optative make up 35%. This reading is attested by at least ten independent lines of transmission, some of which should go back to the 3rd, besides ƒ³⁵. I take it that the Subjunctive is probably original.

εισιν 3:16 A [33%]

The plural is obviously correct. Besides the overt testimony of A, there must be well over twenty independent lines of transmission going back to the 5th century, half of which should go back to the 3rd, besides ƒ³⁵. Let me repeat a statement in the section for 1 Peter.

During the last 150 years the ‘harder reading’ canon has been widely used to impute to John, Peter, etc. a variety of linguistic barbarities; after all, they were ignorant fishermen, Galilean rustics, or whatever. But let’s stop and think for a minute. After Pentecost, as the Church exploded and